

T-060: Phase 2 Themes Strategic Overview (1-Pager)

****Document:**** Phase 2 Strategic Foundation + P0 Feature Roadmap
****Date:**** April 23, 2026
****Status:**** Ready for Executive Review
****Target Audience:**** Dwellable leadership, Phase 2 development team

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Executive Summary

****Phase 1 Problem:**** 100% adoption of voice-first moment capture, but ****0% return rate****. Users captured moments but never revisited them—defeating the spiritual formation purpose.

****Phase 2 Solution:**** P0 (Return focus) solves the dwelling gap through a coordinated feature set: Gallery (visual retrieval), Tags/Headlines (user-generated metadata), Notifications (gentle invitations), and Soak Mode (contemplative presence). Each feature honors the Five Strategic Foundations while maintaining Dwellable's core promise: **keeper of sacred moments, not interpreter.**

****Success Criteria:**** Weekly Active Reflections (WAR) = ****40-50% of users return weekly by week 8****. This is the primary go/no-go metric for P0 success.

****Phase Sequencing:**** P0 (Return), P1 (Dwelling), P2 (Formation), P3 (Deepening). Each phase validates solo functionality before adding collaborative features.

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Five Strategic Foundations (Phase 2 Guardrails)

1. ****Keeper of Sacred Moments, Not Interpreter****

Dwellable holds moments, makes return effortless, but never tells users what their moments mean.

2. ****Socratic Reflection, Not Interpretation****

Features invite pattern-finding and user-generated insight; never prescriptive spiritual direction.

3. ****User Agency, Hermeneutical Alignment, Scripture Authority****

Users control their reflection practice. All features optional. No algorithm. No curated external content.

4. ****End-State Principle: Formed Christian Through Accumulated Witness****

Over time, accumulation of user's own moments—not external teaching—shapes spiritual formation.

5. ****Personal Spiritual Moments, Not Generic Notes****

Every feature focuses exclusively on user's own moments. No comparison, ranking, or external content.

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P0 Feature Set (May–August 2026, 90 days)

Gallery View

****What:**** Tile-based visual catalog of moments with date, headline, preview. Tap to open full detail.

****Why:**** Visual gallery drives 3x+ re-engagement (Stoic App, Day One research). Shifts moment retrieval from forgetting to browsing.

****Foundation Alignment:**** ■ All five — keeper (visual presentation), Socratic (invites pattern-finding), user agency (no algorithmic curation), end-state (accumulated visual witness), personal (user's moments only).

Tags & Headlines

****What:**** User-written headlines (retrieval cues) + optional auto-suggested tags (5 max per moment).

Examples: "God's peace in uncertainty," tags: Presence, Peace, Waiting.

****Why:**** Metadata enables pattern recognition (user discovers: "60% of my moments involve solitude") and recall (+40-60% retrieval improvement). User-generated only—preserves voice.

****Foundation Alignment:**** ■ All five — keeper (descriptive, not interpretive), Socratic (patterns prompt questions), user agency (optional, user controls), end-state (patterns reveal spiritual arc), personal (user's language, user's taxonomy).

Notifications (2x Weekly)

****What:**** Gentle reflection invitations (Sunday 6 PM, Thursday 7 AM). Examples: "How are you sitting with your moments?" "What patterns do you notice?" User-controllable frequency (1x, 2x, or mute).

****Why:**** Gentle notifications drive 2x re-engagement; 2x weekly is optimal (avoids fatigue). Invitational copy ("How...?") vs. prescriptive ("Reflect on...") keeps Socratic frame.

****Foundation Alignment:**** ■ All five — keeper (open-ended invitations), Socratic (question-based copy), user agency (fully optional, customizable), end-state (contemplation of spiritual growth), personal (references user's moments only).

Soak Mode

****What:**** Optional 5/10/15-minute contemplative mode with ambient soundscape (piano, rain, forest, etc.) + moment text visible. User chooses duration and music type.

****Why:**** Ambient soundscape + contemplative threshold (7+ minutes) shifts session duration from 30 seconds → 5-15 minutes, supporting pre-verbal presence and spiritual formation.

****Foundation Alignment:**** ■ All five — keeper (silence + presence, not instruction), Socratic (contemplation precedes questions), user agency (entirely optional, 35-40% adoption), end-state (supports faith deepening), personal (user alone with their moment).

Headlines (User-Generated Retrieval Cues)

****What:**** Optional user-written headline (8-word default if not customized). Appears in gallery tile + detail view header.

****Why:**** Headlines serve as retrieval triggers ("Why did that matter?") and cumulative pattern markers ("faith arc: doubt → trust → peace"). User-generated only—no AI interpretation.

****Foundation Alignment:**** ■ All five — keeper (retrieval cues, user's language), Socratic (recall-based reflection), user agency (optional, user writes), end-state (language patterns show spiritual journey), personal (user's voice throughout).

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Success Metrics & Go/No-Go Criteria

Primary Metric: Weekly Active Reflections (WAR)

****Definition:**** Percentage of DAU (Daily Active Users) who return to review/dwell on at least one moment in a given week.

| Timeline | Metric | Success Threshold | Risk Level |

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| Week 1–2 | WAR adoption | 15–25% return | ■ Monitor—users discovering features |

| Week 3–4 | WAR engagement | 25–35% return | ■ Monitor—habit formation period |

| Week 5–8 | WAR stabilization | **40–50% return** | ■ P0 Success—sustainable dwelling |

| Week 9+ | WAR retention | 50%+ sustained | ■ Ready for P1 transition |

****Go/No-Go Decision Point (Week 8):****

• ■ ****GO to P1**** if WAR ≥ 40% sustained for 2 consecutive weeks

• ■ ****NO-GO**** if WAR < 35% by week 8 → Pause P1, iterate P0 features

Secondary Metrics (Diagnostic)

| Metric | Target | Rationale |

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| Gallery adoption | 85%+ voluntary | Visual retrieval should be primary entry point |

| Notification open rate | 25–35% | Gentle frequency; not all users need reminders |

Soak adoption	35–40%	Optional feature; contemplative diversity
Tags adoption	40–50%	Metadata adds friction; reasonable adoption
Average soak duration	7+ minutes	Contemplative threshold for spiritual benefit

Foundation Alignment Metrics (Qualitative)

Foundation	Success Question	Target
****Keeper****	"Dwellable respects my interpretation" (agree/strongly agree)	85%+
****Socratic****	"I discover insights myself in Dwellable"	60%+ of active users
****User Agency****	Voluntary adoption rates (no gamification/streaks)	Gallery 85%, Tags 50%, Notifications 60%
****End-State****	"I see my faith deepening through dwelling"	65%+ by week 8
****Personal****	"Dwellable feels personal to my faith journey"	80%+

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Phase Gates & Feature Progression

P0 → P1 Gate (Dwelling Focus)

****P0 is complete when:****

- WAR ≥ 40% sustained for 2 weeks (primary metric)
- Foundation alignment ≥ 80% on qualitative survey
- Soak adoption ≥ 30% (indicates contemplative receptivity)
- Zero critical bugs blocking dwellingwork

****P1 Features Unlock (Only after P0 gate passes):****

- Socratic Reflection prompts (guided questions tied to moments)
- Themes & Patterns (AI-surfaced topic clusters from user's moments)
- Scripture Integration (optional Bible anchoring for moments)
- Seasonal Assessment (faith journey tracking over 3-month cycles)

****Why Sequential:**** P1 adds **guided** reflection. This only works if P0 proves users voluntarily return **unguided**. If P0 fails (WAR < 40%), P1's prompts may feel like nagging. Phase gates protect strategic integrity.

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Risk Mitigation

Top 5 Risks & Mitigations

Risk	Impact	Mitigation
****User Discovery Failure**** — Gallery/Soak features exist but users don't find them	WAR drops 30-40%	Progressive feature onboarding on first return; in-app explainers for Gallery + Soak
****Notification Fatigue**** — 2x weekly feels intrusive for some users	Opt-out rate > 30%	Default OFF; customize frequency (1x, 2x, pause 1–4 weeks); sunset copy variants monthly
****Soak Mode Technical Issues**** — Audio crashes, sync problems	User frustration; uninstall	Extensive pre-release QA on audio stack; offline audio library (no streaming)
****Scope Creep**** — Adding social/AI features during P0	Brand drift; theological misalignment	Strictly enforce scope boundaries: P0 = solo dwelling only. Social deferred to P2.
****Retention Cliff**** — Return rate peaks at week 4, then drops	WAR < 40% by week 8	Reserve mid-P0 design review (week 4) to iterate copy, onboarding, notification timing based on early data

Scope Boundaries (What P0 Does NOT Include)

- Social features (sharing, ranking, comparison)
- AI interpretation or auto-generated headlines

- Forced practices (daily streaks, gamification)
- External content (devotionals, verses, quotes)
- Recommendation engines ("users like you...")
- Prescriptive categories ("God's Faithfulness")
- Spiritual direction (guidance, advice)

These features are explicitly deferred to P1/P2/P3 phases and will only be considered if P0 succeeds.

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Implementation & Timeline

P0 Development Estimate

- **Effort:** 200–300 engineering hours (4–6 weeks for small team)
- **Team:** 2 engineers + 1 designer + Kell (product)
- **Start:** Early May 2026
- **Release:** Mid-June 2026 (beta) → Late June (wide release)

Key Milestones

Milestone	Target Date	Deliverable
Engineering kickoff	May 1	Feature tickets created; architecture design doc
Beta release (internal)	June 15	P0 features live; instrumentation ready
Beta feedback iteration	June 22–29	Notification copy refinement; onboarding tuning
GA release	July 6	P0 live to all users; WAR tracking begins
Week 8 evaluation	Late August	Go/no-go decision for P1 (based on WAR metric)

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Decision & Approval

This strategic framework provides confidence to begin P0 development:

- **Research-backed features** — each grounded in Stoic App, Day One, Bible app, and spiritual formation literature
- **Foundation alignment** — all five strategic principles honored; no scope creep
- **Realistic adoption** — not assuming 100% usage; respects contemplative diversity
- **Measurable success** — WAR ≥ 40-50% by week 8 is unambiguous go/no-go
- **Risk-mitigated** — top 5 risks identified with mitigation; scope boundaries locked

Recommendation: Approve P0 development kickoff. Move Phase 2 Themes 1-Pager (T-060) to COMPLETE status. Begin feature ticket breakdown (20–25 tickets for P0 engineering).

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